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# Up to ₹5 lakh to buy farm land, *in a woman's name.*

*A plain guide to Tamil Nadu's Nannilam Magalir Nila Udamai Thittam: who it is for, what you actually get, and how to apply.*

Tamil Nadu runs a scheme that pays half the price of agricultural land, up to ₹5 lakh, so that landless women farm workers can own the land they work on. It is a real scheme and the benefit is large. It is also a narrow one, so I've laid out the rules first and the excitement second. Read the eligibility page before you go looking at land.

1. **Half the land price is paid for you.** 50% of the cost, capped at ₹5 lakh per family, plus stamp duty and registration fee waived.
2. **It is only for SC and ST women.** Landless, working in agriculture, family income up to ₹3 lakh a year. It is not for houses or city plots.
3. **The land is locked for 10 years.** You cannot sell or transfer it in that time, and it is registered only in your name.

| SUBSIDY | MAX PER FAMILY | STAMP DUTY | LOCK-IN |
|---|---|---|---|
| 50% | ₹5 lakh | ₹0 | 10 yrs |

PART 1 · WHAT THE SCHEME IS

# A land subsidy, *not a cash gift*

What the government is paying for, who runs it, and where it came from.

## 1 The scheme in one paragraph

The **Nannilam Magalir Nila Udamai Thittam** (roughly, "good land, women's land ownership scheme") helps landless Adi Dravidar (Scheduled Caste) and Scheduled Tribe women who work in agriculture to buy farm land in their own name. The government pays up to **50% of the land cost, capped at ₹5 lakh**, and waives the **stamp duty and registration fee** on the purchase. You find the land, the subsidy goes towards buying it, and the land is registered only in your name.

It is run by **TAHDCO** (Tamil Nadu Adi Dravidar Housing and Development Corporation) under the state's Adi Dravidar and Tribal Welfare Department. The government notified it in the Tamil Nadu Gazette through G.O. (Ms.) No. 92, dated 17 October 2024, which also makes Aadhaar mandatory for anyone claiming the benefit.

## 2 Where it came from

| VERSION | SUBSIDY | CAP | LOCK-IN |
|---|---|---|---|
| **TAHDCO Land Purchase Scheme (from 2004-05)** | 30% | ₹2.25 lakh | 20 yrs |
| **Nannilam Magalir Nila Udamai Thittam (2024 onwards)** | 50% | ₹5 lakh | 10 yrs |

*Older figures still appear on some district websites. The current TAHDCO scheme page shows 50% / ₹5 lakh / 10 years. If you see 30% or ₹2.25 lakh somewhere, that is the old scheme.*

BEFORE YOU GET EXCITED

Here is who this scheme is **not** for. It is not for every woman in Tamil Nadu, only SC and ST women. It is not for a house, a flat or a residential plot, only agricultural land. It is not free money you can spend: the subsidy goes into buying the land. And you still need to arrange the other half of the price yourself. If any of these rule you out, I'd rather you know now than after paying an advance to a seller.

THE ONE THING TO NOTICE

The scheme pays half the price of the land. The other half, and the paperwork, is still on you.

PART 2 · WHO CAN APPLY

# Check every line *before anything else*

All of these have to be true. If even one is not, the application will not go through.

## 3 The eligibility checklist

| RULE | WHAT IT MEANS |
|---|---|
| **Community** | Adi Dravidar (Scheduled Caste) or Scheduled Tribe. You need a community certificate. |
| **Who applies** | A woman of the family. TAHDCO's rules say that only if there is no eligible woman in the family can the husband or a son be considered. |
| **Age** | 18 to 65 years, as per the TAHDCO scheme page. (Some news reports say 18 to 55. Go by what the district office tells you.) |
| **Family income** | Not more than ₹3 lakh a year, backed by an income certificate from the Tahsildar. |
| **Occupation** | Agriculture. The scheme is meant for women who work on farms, mostly as agricultural labourers. |
| **Land owned now** | You must not own any agricultural land. |
| **Recent land sales** | Neither you nor your family should have sold or transferred land in the last 5 years. |
| **Past subsidy** | Neither you nor your family should have taken this TAHDCO subsidy before. |
| **Aadhaar** | Required (G.O. No. 92 of 2024). If you have only an enrolment slip, an approved photo ID is accepted in the meantime. |

*Sources: TAHDCO Land Purchase Scheme page; Tamil Nadu Gazette, G.O. (Ms.) No. 92, Adi Dravidar and Tribal Welfare Dept, 17 Oct 2024. Checked November 2026.*

> THIS TOOK ME A WHILE TO GET
>
> The 5-year rule catches people. If your family sold even a small piece of land recently to raise money, you may not qualify, even if you own nothing today.

PART 3 · WHAT YOU ACTUALLY GET

# The subsidy, *worked out in rupees*

Half the land cost, but never more than ₹5 lakh. Here is what that looks like at different land prices.

## 4 Subsidy at different land prices

| LAND COST | GOVT PAYS | YOU PAY | GOVT SHARE | STAMP DUTY SAVED (7%) |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| ₹4,00,000 | ₹2,00,000 | ₹2,00,000 | 50% | ₹28,000 |
| ₹6,00,000 | ₹3,00,000 | ₹3,00,000 | 50% | ₹42,000 |
| ₹10,00,000 | ₹5,00,000 | ₹5,00,000 | 50% | ₹70,000 |
| ₹14,00,000 | ₹5,00,000 | ₹9,00,000 | 35.7% | ₹98,000 |
| ₹20,00,000 | ₹5,00,000 | ₹15,00,000 | 25% | ₹1,40,000 |

*Govt pays = the lower of 50% of land cost or ₹5,00,000. Stamp duty at Tamil Nadu's 7% on the land value. The registration fee is also waived and is extra savings on top of this column. Examples only.*

> THE ONE THING TO NOTICE
>
> ₹10 lakh is the sweet spot. Below it you get a full 50%. Above it, the ₹5 lakh cap stays fixed and your share grows fast.

## 5 Which price counts

TAHDCO says the land cost must follow **government guidelines**. In practice that means the price is checked against the land's **guideline value** (the government's official rate for that survey number, which you can look up on the TNREGINET website). If a seller asks well above the guideline value, don't assume the subsidy will cover 50% of whatever you agree to pay. Ask the TAHDCO District Manager how your land will be valued before you sign anything.

The subsidy is a **front-end subsidy**. It goes towards the purchase itself, after your application is verified, rather than being paid back to you years later.

PART 4 · THE REAL RETURN

# What you gain, *and what it costs you*

This is not an investment with an interest rate. The "return" is owning an asset for about half its price. Here is how I'd look at it.

## 6 On a ₹10 lakh piece of land

| ITEM | AMOUNT | NOTE |
|---|---|---|
| **Land value** | ₹10,00,000 | At guideline value |
| **Subsidy from the scheme** | ₹5,00,000 | 50%, at the cap |
| **Stamp duty you don't pay** | ₹70,000 | 7% of ₹10 lakh |
| **Registration fee you don't pay** | Waived | Extra saving, depends on current rate |
| **Your money in** | ₹5,00,000 | From savings or a bank loan |

*Without the scheme the same land would cost ₹10,70,000 plus registration fee. With it, ₹5,00,000. Worked out in a script; rounded to the rupee.*

## 7 The costs people forget

WHAT YOU GET

- Land in your own name, for about half its price
- No stamp duty or registration fee on it
- A place to farm instead of working only on others' land
- An asset the family keeps, as long as you hold the rules

WHAT IT COSTS YOU

- Your 50% share, in cash or as a loan with interest
- Money to develop it: well, borewell, pump set, fencing
- 10 years when you cannot sell, even in an emergency
- Farm income that depends on water, rain and crop prices

A SHORTCUT I USE NOW

Before applying, write down three numbers: your share of the land price, how much of it is a loan, and the monthly EMI on that loan. If the EMI only works in a good crop year, the land will feel like a burden, not a gain. TAHDCO's page also mentions help for wells and pump sets under NABARD guidelines, so ask about that at the district office too.

PART 5 · THE CONDITIONS ON THE LAND

# Rules that come *with the land*

These apply to the land you choose and to what you do with it after you buy.

## 8 The land rules

| RULE | WHAT IT MEANS FOR YOU |
|---|---|
| **Type of land** | Agricultural land only. Not a house, a flat or a residential plot. |
| **How much land** | As reported, up to 2.5 acres of wet land (nanjai) or 5 acres of dry land (punjai). Confirm the exact limit with the district office. |
| **Who picks the land** | You do. The scheme does not hand you a plot. |
| **Who you buy from** | The seller must not be from an SC or ST community. |
| **Whose name** | Registered only in the applicant's name. No joint names. |
| **Price** | Must follow government guidelines (guideline value). |
| **Lock-in** | You cannot sell or transfer the land for 10 years from purchase. |

*Sources: TAHDCO Land Purchase Scheme page; land-extent limits as reported by Zee News Tamil. Checked November 2026.*

WHAT FINALLY SETTLED IT FOR ME

The 10-year lock-in is the price of the subsidy. If you might need to sell within 10 years, this scheme is the wrong tool.

ABOUT "ONLY TWO CONDITIONS"

You may have heard this scheme summed up as "no other land, and no selling for 10 years". Those two are real, but they are not the full list. The community, income, age, occupation, 5-year sale rule, past-subsidy rule and the seller rule all apply too. Go through Part 2 and this page together.

# Get the papers ready *before you apply*

Two lists: papers about you, and papers about the land. Tick them off as you go.

## 9 About you

- [ ] **Community certificate** showing SC or ST.
- [ ] **Income certificate** from the Tahsildar, family income up to ₹3 lakh.
- [ ] **Aadhaar card** and **family (ration) card**.
- [ ] **Certificate from the VAO** that you are landless and work in agriculture (asked for by many district offices).
- [ ] **Bank passbook** (first page) and a working **mobile number** for the OTP.
- [ ] **Passport-size photo**.

## 10 About the land

- [ ] **Patta and chitta** in the seller's name, matching the survey number.
- [ ] **Adangal** showing the land is used for agriculture.
- [ ] **Encumbrance Certificate (EC)** showing no loan or dispute on the land.
- [ ] **Seller's previous sale deed** (parent document).
- [ ] **Guideline value** for that survey number, printed from TNREGINET.
- [ ] **Geologist's feasibility certificate**, if you plan to dig a well with scheme help.

*The exact list can differ by district. Collect the checklist from the TAHDCO District Manager's office before you start.*

> THE ONE THING TO NOTICE
>
> Check the land papers before you pay the seller any advance. The subsidy can't fix a land title that has a problem.

PART 7 · HOW TO APPLY

# From eligibility *to registration*

You can apply online or at the district office. The order of steps is roughly the same either way.

## 11 Step by step

1 **Confirm you qualify.** Go through the checklist in Part 2. If you're unsure about any line, call or visit the TAHDCO District Manager's office (usually in the Collectorate campus).

2 **Get your own documents.** Community, income and VAO certificates take time. Start these first.

3 **Shortlist the land.** Agricultural, within the acreage limit, from a non-SC/ST seller, with clean papers. Check the guideline value.

4 **Apply online.** Go to **newscheme.tahdco.com**, pick "Nannilam Magalir Nila Udamai Thittam", verify your mobile number with OTP, fill the form and upload the documents. Or collect and submit the form at the district office.

5 **Verification.** Officials check your eligibility and the land. Keep your phone on and the original papers ready.

6 **Arrange your share.** Line up your 50% from savings or a bank loan. Don't commit to a loan before the subsidy is sanctioned.

7 **Register the land.** Registration in your name only, with stamp duty and registration fee waived under the scheme. Keep the sanction order and the sale deed safe.

8 **Track the status.** The same portal has an "Application Status" option.

## 12 Who to contact

| WHERE | DETAILS |
|---|---|
| **District level** | TAHDCO District Manager's office in your district |
| **Online portal** | newscheme.tahdco.com (also tahdco.com) |
| **TAHDCO head office** | No. 31, Cenotaph Road, Teynampet, Chennai 600018 · 044 2431 0221 |

*Contact details as shown on the TAHDCO portal, November 2026. Applications open as per each year's fund allocation, so the portal may not always be accepting forms.*

WORDS YOU'LL HEAR

# The glossary, *in plain words*

Every term in this guide, explained once.

### TAHDCO
TN ADI DRAVIDAR HOUSING AND DEV. CORP.

The state corporation that runs this scheme and other SC/ST welfare schemes.

*"Intha scheme-a nadathura government office."*

### Adi Dravidar
SCHEDULED CASTE (SC)

Tamil Nadu's term for Scheduled Caste communities.

*"SC community-oda Tamil Nadu per."*

### ST
SCHEDULED TRIBE

Tribal communities listed by the government. Also eligible here.

*"Malaivaazh makkal community."*

### Subsidy
MAANIYAM

Money the government pays towards your cost. Not a loan, so you don't repay it.

*"Thirumba kattavendiya avasiyam illa."*

### Front-end subsidy
PAID AT PURCHASE

The subsidy is used at the time of buying, not refunded later.

*"Vaangum pothey use aagum."*

### Guideline value
GOVT LAND RATE

The official per-unit value of land for each survey number. Used to check the price.

*"Government fix panna land rate."*

### Stamp duty
TAX ON THE SALE DEED

A tax paid when land is bought. 7% in Tamil Nadu. Waived under this scheme.

*"Register panna kattura tax."*

### Registration fee
SUB-REGISTRAR FEE

The fee for recording the sale officially. Also waived here.

*"Sub-registrar office fees."*

### Lock-in
NO-SALE PERIOD

10 years from purchase when the land can't be sold or transferred.

*"Pathu varusham virka mudiyaathu."*

### Patta
OWNERSHIP RECORD

Revenue record showing who owns the land.

*"Nilam yaar perla irukku nu kaatum."*

### Chitta
LAND DETAILS RECORD

Shows the land's extent, type and owner, kept by the VAO.

*"Nilam evvalavu, enna type nu solum."*

### Adangal
VILLAGE LAND REGISTER

Shows how the land is used, for example which crop is grown.

*"Nilathula enna payir nu record."*

### EC
ENCUMBRANCE CERTIFICATE

Lists past transactions and any loans on the land.

*"Nilathu mela kadan irukka nu check."*

### Nanjai / Punjai
WET LAND / DRY LAND

Nanjai is irrigated wet land. Punjai is rain-fed dry land.

*"Thanni nilam, maanaavaari nilam."*

### VAO
VILLAGE ADMINISTRATIVE OFFICER

The village revenue officer who issues local certificates.

*"Ooru level revenue officer."*

SOURCES AND DISCLAIMER

# How the *numbers* were worked out

Every rule and figure in this guide, and where it came from. Checked in November 2026.

1. **Subsidy (50% or ₹5 lakh, whichever is less), stamp duty and registration fee waiver, 10-year lock-in, eligibility (SC women, age 18 to 65, income up to ₹3 lakh, landless, agriculture, no subsidy before, no land sold in 5 years), seller must be non-SC/ST, registration in applicant's name only:** TAHDCO, Land Purchase Scheme page (tahdco.com/land-purchase-scheme.php).
2. **Scheme name, inclusion of ST women, Aadhaar requirement:** Tamil Nadu Government Gazette Extraordinary, G.O. (Ms.) No. 92, Adi Dravidar and Tribal Welfare Department, 17 October 2024.
3. **Online application and status tracking, head office contact:** TAHDCO scheme portal (newscheme.tahdco.com).
4. **Old scheme terms (30%, ₹2.25 lakh, 20 years):** TAHDCO scheme listing on Kancheepuram district website (kancheepuram.nic.in).
5. **Land extent (2.5 acres wet / 5 acres dry), 18 to 55 age figure, offline application at district office:** Zee News Tamil report on the scheme. News source, not official; confirm with TAHDCO.
6. **Document list (VAO certificate, patta, chitta, adangal, EC):** Zee News Tamil (2026) and GoodReturns Tamil (30 Dec 2025) reports. Varies by district.
7. **Stamp duty of 7%:** Tamil Nadu sale deed rate on market or guideline value, as listed by ClearTax and HomeFirst (2026). Check current rates on tnreginet.gov.in.
8. **Method:** subsidy = the lower of 50% of land cost or ₹5,00,000. Stamp duty saved = 7% of land cost. All examples computed in a script and rounded to the rupee. Land prices are examples, not real listings.


DISCLAIMER

This guide is for education only. It is not investment, tax or legal advice, and it does not recommend any specific land, seller, bank or agent. I am not a SEBI-registered investment adviser and I am not connected with TAHDCO or the Government of Tamil Nadu. Scheme rules, limits, fund allocations and application windows are set by the government and can change at any time, and some details differ between districts. Land purchase carries legal risk, so get the title checked by a lawyer. Confirm every condition with the TAHDCO District Manager's office or tahdco.com before you pay any money or sign any document.


## Know a woman this could help? *Send her this guide.*

Free to share. Made by Abinash at **@buildwithabinash**. Send this to someone in your family or village who works on a farm and has never owned the land.